# *Appendix D.*

To ensure a platform's maintainability and usefulness, we should consider the way it will be started as well as the processes of removing obsolete elements. Good practice is to start small and build up, and to remove elements in a controlled fashion, not disrupting operations of platform users. This appendix presents the concepts of the thinnest viable platform (which, as its name suggests, is a method for starting small) and steps for unobtrusive removal of deprecated interfaces.

## *D.1 Notes on thinnest viable platforms*

The Team Topologies approach includes the concept of a *thinnest viable platform* (*TVP*). We like that idea and believe that, in general, when developing an internal platform, you should always create the platform as the most stripped-down version you can imagine.

The TVP will almost always turn out to be a simple wiki page with an explanation of the few standardized technologies and processes in use. For a data mesh TVP, the wiki page could even include the metadata for the products. After all, you will be starting out with one or two data products, and these will surely fit onto one page.

This exercise will hopefully help you start with a simple and lean platform. Once you write the wiki page, look at it and list the next iterations and see where the most value lies.

**NOTE** If you're interested in non-data-mesh data TVPs, take a look at the TVP Examples GitHub site at http://mng.bz/69Qe.

## *D.2 Note on phasing out interfaces*

If you keep on modifying the platform kernel but never delete any parts, or do some heavier reorganization, the platform itself will become heavy and too slow to adapt to change, too complex to handle.